

1. Quoting Linus Torvalds

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-22T21:04:26+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/22/linus-torvalds/>

And this was a debug session from hell, enormously helped by an AI doing much of the grunt-work. I'd like to call it my tireless helper, but the AI several times stated flat out that this was impossible and unsolvable and that we should just write a report about it. I suspect those things have been trained by people who may not be quite as stubborn as I am. But while the AI was ready to give up several times, it did keep adding debug code and analyzing it faithfully when I pushed. So credit where credit is due and I let the AI write the commit message above. ? Linus Torvalds , drm/xe: Don't hand out the flat CCS storage as usable VRAM
Tags: linus-torvalds , linux , generative-ai , ai-assisted-programming , ai , llms

2. llm 0.33

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-22T17:01:16+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/22/llm/>

Release: llm 0.33 My highlights from this release: Upgraded to the OpenAI Python library 3.x and switched the HTTP client dependency from httpx to httpx2 . #1608 , #1631 I shipped a quick 0.32.1 fix for this yesterday, but this is the more comprehensive fix. llm embed and llm embed-multi now accept --key . The Python EmbeddingModel.embed() , EmbeddingModel.embed_multi() , Collection.embed() and Collection.embed_multi() methods accept key= too, passing the resolved per-call key to embedding plugins without changing shared model state. Existing plugins that read self.key continue to work through a compatibility fallback. Thanks, ChrisJr404 . #757 , #1620 The embedding models now use the same pattern for keys that regular LLM models do. llm prompt -t/--template can now be repeated to combine templates in order. This allows model configuration and options from one template to be used with a prompt from another. This unlocks a neat pattern where you can create templates that package a model with a set of default options: llm -m gpt-5.6-luna -o reasoning_effort high --save lhigh llm "Generate an SVG of a pelican riding a bicycle" --save pelican # Combine and run the templates llm -t lhi...

3. More than just code review

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-22T15:56:54+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/22/more-than-just-code-review/>

The key skill required to make productive use of coding agents is being able to confidently instruct them on how to make changes and then confidently verify that those changes have been applied in the correct way. Sometimes this involves reviewing every line of code they have written, but there are other ways to achieve that goal. Eyeballing every line of code has never been the most effective way to validate a chance to a piece of software. Tags: code-review , coding-agents , generative-ai , agentic-engineering , ai , llms

4. Mark Carney on the U.S. Under Trump: ?Sometimes, Its Signature Is Written in Pencil?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-22T16:47:10Z

Link: https://www.nytimes.com/2026/08/22/world/canada/carney-tariffs-trade-trump.html?unlocked_article_code=1.7VA.r3Ue.GTc_tOhX0qSn

Ian Austen, reporting for The New York Times (gift link): The morning after he pulled negotiators from trade talks in Washington and set off a new round of American tariffs, Prime Minister Mark Carney on Saturday explained to Canadians why he walked away, calling the U.S. proposal ?a bad deal.? ?We've recognized from the start that America has changed,? Mr. Carney said. ?We recognize that sometimes, its signature is written in pencil.? ?We cannot accept what they offered and we will not give what they asked,? he added. ?We were not prepared to compromise Canada's sovereignty or undermine our key industries.? If only Sharpie made pencils. Carney is rising to the moment and showing the rest of the world how to deal with the Trump administration. Trump is erratic, emotionally unstable, ignorant, and dishonest. Carney is

consistent, steadfast, knowledgeable, and honest. The only correct way to deal with a con man is to cut him off and call him out for what he is. ?

5. WorkOS: Agents Can Now Sign Up for Your App

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-22T14:18:29Z

Link:

https://workos.com/auth-md?utm_source=daringfireball&utm_medium=newsletter&utm_campaign=q32026

My thanks to WorkOS for sponsoring the Daring Fireball weekly newsletter this week to promote their Agent Registration. Agents are hitting your signup flow and they're bouncing off a browser login that was designed for humans. Every one that gives up is a signup you never see. WorkOS Agent Registration turns that traffic into signups. Enroll via the dashboard and AuthKit publishes an auth.md file that agents read to register for scoped, short-lived credentials you control. Make your app agent-ready today . ?

6. Dutch Regulator Fines Uber \$1 Billion for Suspending Dishonest Drivers

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-22T14:12:07Z

Link: <https://www.reuters.com/world/dutch-regulator-fines-uber-966-million-automating-driver-suspensions-document-2026-08-21/>

Toby Sterling, reporting for Reuters: The Dutch Data Protection Authority has fined Uber ?825 million (\$966 million) for deactivating driver accounts through automated systems without adequately informing them, according to an August 17 decision reviewed by Reuters. The penalty would be the second-largest issued yet under Europe?s General Data Protection Regulation. It is behind only a ?1.2 billion fine imposed on Meta by Ireland in 2023 for unlawfully transferring European ?Facebook users? data to the United States. Meta is appealing. Uber said it would also appeal. [...] The Dutch authority confirmed the decision later on Friday. ?Uber has committed ?serious infringements,? in deactivating driver accounts without warning or human involvement, the organisation?s deputy chair Monique Verdier said in a statement. ?From one moment ?to the next they no longer had any income ... A computer should not make decisions on its own that have (such) major consequences.? Saying that ?a computer? made these decisions is like saying that when a company suspends or fires a habitually late employee, that ?the time clock? made the decision. Managers at the company set the policies, and the devices...

7. Fast and Hard Code

Source: Armin Ronacher's Thoughts and Writings | Published: 2026-08-22T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://lucumr.pocoo.org/2026/8/22/fast-hard-code/>

One of the memes on Twitter is that ?programming is solved now.? I?m not sure to what degree it is, but one thing is pretty clear: the act of familiarizing yourself with a language no longer matters and some of the friction that mattered for humans does not matter for agents. As a result, LLMs make language choice much less consequential than it used to be. If you don?t like the choice, you can seemingly rewrite it in another language and you can make it pick a language that you, as a programmer, are entirely unfamiliar with. Which in turn means that people can, and do, choose based on the marketing of languages much more. As a long-term Rust programmer I found it quite fascinating to see people now ship Rust code who previously might not have chosen it. I attribute at least one part of this to two recent vibe shifts: there is a lot more talk about wanting fast software, and about LLMs being exceptional at optimizing code without regressing behavior. Folks like Mitchell Hashimoto, Charlie Marsh, Jarred Sumner, Daniel Lemire and quite a few others always carried a certain level of obsession with fast and performant software and they also all happen to be receptive to agents writing...

8. The difference orbit inclination makes

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 23 Aug 2026 00:01:10 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/22/inclination/>

Suppose you wanted to find the distance between Earth and Mars over time. To first approximation, both planets orbit the sun in elliptic orbits in the same plane. If you wanted to be more accurate, you?d need to take into account the fact that the orbit of Mars is tilted

about 1.85° relative to the [?] The post The difference orbit inclination makes first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. Coming soon

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 22 Aug 2026 15:34:11 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/22/coming-soon/>

There's a pizza shop near my home with a sign out front that says "Coming Soon." When I drove by it this morning I thought about how you would model the time until an event happens that is "coming soon." Suppose I look at the sign one day and guess how many days until the [?] The post Coming soon first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Vim's UserGettingBored autocmd

Source: Evan Hahn (dot com) | Published: Sat, 22 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://evanhahn.com/usergettingbored-vim/>

In short: Vim has a joke autocmd called UserGettingBored that doesn't do anything. Vim's automatic commands feature, usually shortened to "autocmd", lets you run code when various events occur. For example, you could implement an auto-save feature by binding the TextChanged event to the :w command. Vim has over 100 events, from "buffer was created" to "file was saved". But one of them sticks out to me: UserGettingBored . Here's the documentation: UserGettingBored : When the user presses the same key 42 times. Just kidding! :-) When I saw this, I was busy doing something else and it completely derailed me. "I must know more," I thought. Here's what I found: Unfortunately, it doesn't do anything. It only exists in the documentation (and some tests). If you try to use it with something like autocmd UserGettingBored ... , you'll get a "no such group or event" error. It's present in Vim , Neovim , and Vim Classic . It was first added by Bram Moolenaar in July 2000 , over a year before Vim 6.0 was released. The original description was, "When the user hits CTRL-C. Just kidding!" And it didn't do anything back then, so I don't think it's ever been real. In August 2001, he added the smil...

11. This Week in Package Management: 22 August 2026

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-08-22T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/08/22/this-week-in-package-management.html>

Week fourteen of the roundup, built from the package manager OPML feed collection and whatever I've posted or boosted on Mastodon . Releases Go 1.27 is out. On the module side, go mod tidy now consolidates duplicate require blocks into the canonical direct/indirect pair for modules declaring go 1.27 or later, go doc accepts package@version to fetch documentation for a specific module version, and the go command drops support for fetching modules from Bazaar repositories. A compress/flate encoder change also means archive/zip and compress/gzip produce different bytes than under Go 1.26, which is worth checking anywhere a Go-built tool's archive output is hash-pinned downstream (forge tarball endpoints, module proxies, release pipelines). Rust 1.98 ships Cargo with an unstable -Zmin-publish-age flag implementing RFC 3923 : resolution filters out crate versions published more recently than a configured threshold. It also fixes a 1.96 Windows regression in cargo:token-from-stdout credential providers. Bun 1.4 is the first release of the Rust rewrite , the bulk of which Jarred Sumner produced from the Zig codebase with Claude Code workflows. It fills out the package manager subcommands...

12. Reading List 08/22/26

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 22 Aug 2026 12:02:58 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-082226>

Los Angeles? ADUs, electrical transformer manufacturing, gas turbine power plants, how water in the Colorado River is used, and more.

13. A Syncthing and SQLite Gotcha

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Sun, 23 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +1000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/a-syncthing-and-sqlite-gotcha>

On the rename system call.

14. Concurrent Servers: Part 8 - Go

Source: Eli Bendersky's website | Published: 2026-08-22T07:52:00-07:00

Link: <https://eli.thegreenplace.net/2026/concurrent-servers-part-8-go/>

This is part 8 in a series of posts on writing concurrent network servers. In this part, we'll switch to Go and see how it tackles the challenges described earlier in the series. All posts in the series: Part 1 - Introduction Part 2 - Threads Part 3 - Event-driven Part 4 - libuv ?

15. the figure of the earth

Source: computers are bad | Published: 22 Aug 2026 00:00:00 UT

Link: <https://computer.rip/2026-08-22-figure-of-the-earth.html>

Brigadier Martin Hotine is not quite the image of a decorated officer. His name is styled with trailing acronyms that make it no surprise that there is an official portrait, yet in that painting he appears disheveled, his tie far off center in the collar of his jacket. He leans off to one side, not quite like he is sitting for a portrait, but more like he was caught in the middle of something. Photos of the man are often similar: he's distracted, looking down at his desk or staring into space. His mind seems to be elsewhere. Hotine had a lot to think about. His duties in the First and Second World Wars had only been a distraction from the real work of his career: the precise measurement of the whole British Empire. Late in Hotine's career, he was honored not only by his own country (as a Commander of the Order of the British Empire) but by the United States as well (named an Officer of the Legion of Merit). Most of his awards, though, reflected the technical nature of his work: the Founder's Medal of the Royal Geographical Society, and shortly after his death in 1968, the Gold Medal of the United States Department of Commerce. Ribbons and medals, though, do not quite capture the b...